

Conference approval by department director Terry Sejnowski

T terry
Re: Co-organization of Science of Consciousness Conference
To: Arnaud Delorme

March 3, 2026 at 19:00

Arnaud -

Thanks for organizing this meeting.

Let me know if you run into any issues.

Terry

On 3/3/2026 5:49 PM, Arnaud Delorme wrote:
Hi Terry and Gert,

We decided to **rename the conference from TSC 2026 to CS 2026**, for Consciousness Science 2026. After 32 years as TSC, Stuart agreed it was a good time for a refresh, and the new name still keeps continuity with the history of the meeting. The conference is planned for the second week of October at Paradise Point Resort. The meeting continues in its biennial US format with Stuart agreeing to transfer it to San Diego for future editions.

The announcement should go out in the next few weeks. The program will largely follow what had been planned for Arizona, with speakers who had already agreed to participate. Most have already reconfirmed, and none have withdrawn. **Terry, would you be interested in giving a plenary talk related to consciousness research?** Other speakers include Edward Boyden (MITy), Robin Carhart Harris (UCSF), Michael Levin (Tufts), Edward Large (University of Connecticut), Andre Bastos (Vanderbilt), Martin Picard (Columbia), and Roger Penrose (University of Oxford). We reviewed all plenary speakers in light of the recent disclosures and removed three. I attached a short document for transparency.

I will serve as Program Chair. As before, my role is limited to the scientific side and does not involve finances. The Associate Chairs will be Susan Schneider at Florida Atlantic University, Thomas Brophy at IONS, Tracy Brandmeyer at Gogenetics and BrainMind, and Stuart Hameroff at the University of Arizona. Abi Behar Montefiore will remain conference manager. We will put clear emphasis on **early career researchers, underrepresented groups, and a diversity of scientific perspectives in shaping the program**. There will also be a workshop on women in consciousness research, and a new code of conduct.

Given that UCSD is not financially involved, I assume no additional administrative steps are needed, but please let me know if you think otherwise.

The provisional website, not yet publicly announced, is <https://consciousness.ucsd.edu>
I am happy to jump on a call to discuss if needed.

Best,

Arno

Conference approval by department co-director Gert Cauwenberghs

From: Gert Cauwenberghs <gcauwenberghs@ucsd.edu>
Subject: Re: Co-organization of Science of Consciousness Conference
Date: March 4, 2026 at 23:18:09 PST
To: Arnaud Delorme <adelorme@ucsd.edu>
Cc: Terrence Sejnowski <terry@salk.edu>

That's all great, thanks for the update! The website looks very professional and inviting to me; perhaps overdoing the attendance & conduct policy but better safe than sorry. No call for papers/abstracts or registration fees?

Gert

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Best,

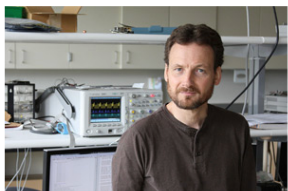
Arno

Meet The Directors



Dr. Terrence Sejnowski is a pioneer in computational neuroscience. His goal is to understand the principles that link brain to behavior. His laboratory uses both experimental and modeling techniques to study the biophysical properties of synapses and neurons and the population dynamics of large networks of neurons. New computational models and new analytical tools have been developed to understand how the brain represents the world and how new representations are formed through learning algorithms for changing the synaptic strengths of connections between neurons. Dr. Sejnowski was instrumental in shaping the BRAIN Initiative that was announced by the White House on April 2, 2013, and served on the Advisory Committee to the Director of NIH for the BRAIN Initiative. He is one of only 10 living persons to be a member of the Institute of Medicine, National Academy of Sciences and the National Academy of Engineering.

Dr. Sejnowski received his Ph.D. in physics from Princeton University and was a postdoctoral fellow in the Department of Neurobiology at Harvard Medical School and on the faculty at the Johns Hopkins University. He is now an Investigator with the Howard Hughes Medical Institute, holds the Francis Crick Chair at [The Salk Institute for Biological Studies](#), and is a Professor of Biology at UC San Diego, where he is co-director of the Institute for Neural Computation and the NSF Temporal Dynamics of Learning Center. Dr. Sejnowski is the President of the Neural Information Processing Systems (NIPS) Foundation, which organizes an annual conference attended by over 2000 researchers in machine learning and neural computation and is the founding editor-in-chief of Neural Computation published by the MIT Press. He also recently wrote ["The Deep Learning Revolution"](#) (MIT Press) and is co-creator with Dr. Barbara Oakley of a Massive Online Open Course (MOOC) for Coursera on ["Learning How to Learn"](#) which is the most popular MOOC currently.



Dr. Gert Cauwenberghs pioneered the design and implementation of highly energy efficient, massively parallel microchips that emulate function and structure of adaptive neural circuits in silicon. Recently the Cauwenberghs group demonstrated synaptic arrays in silicon for adaptive template-based visual pattern recognition operating at less than a femtojoule of energy per synaptic operation, exceeding the nominal energy efficiency of synaptic transmission in the human brain. A main focus of current work is on extending integrated sensing and actuation to dynamical interfaces to neural and brain activity. Recent developments include implantable and wireless microelectrode arrays for distributed recording of electrical and chemical neural activity, and biopotential sensor arrays and integrated signal processing for electroencephalogram and electrocorticogram functional brain imaging. These dynamical interfaces between living and artificial nervous systems offer tremendous

opportunities for transformative, integrative neuroscience and neuroengineering that are the focus of continued research in the Cauwenberghs laboratory, in collaboration with partners in academia, industry, and the clinical sector.

Gert Cauwenberghs received the M.Eng. degree in applied physics from University of Brussels, Belgium, in 1988, and the M.S. and Ph.D. degrees in electrical engineering from California Institute of Technology, Pasadena, in 1989 and 1994. He is [Professor of Bioengineering at University of California San Diego](#), where he co-directs the Institute for Neural Computation. Previously, he held positions as Professor of Electrical and Computer Engineering at Johns Hopkins University, Baltimore Maryland, and as Visiting Professor of Brain and Cognitive Science at Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Cambridge.

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Terry Sejnowski

If Terry approves of the conference, UCSD will consider it acceptable, as he has a strong reputation there.

Cited work is the way scientist reputations are compared. For example, Dante Lauro, the director of the astrobiology department at UA, has [21,000 citations](#). By contrast, Terry Sejnowski, the director of the INC department, has [189,000 citations](#).

[The Brain Prize \(2024\)](#) was shared between Terry Sejnowski, Larry Abbott and Haim Sompolinsky, this award is worth 10 million DKK (approximately \$1.5 million).

Sejnowski was elected to the National Academy of Medicine in 2008. In 2010, he was elected a Member of the National Academy of Sciences (NAS), and elected to the National Academy of Engineering in 2011. In 2017, he was elected to the National Academy of Inventors. These achievements place him in a group of only **three living people to have been elected to all four of the national academies**.

Sejnowski with Obama at the white house

